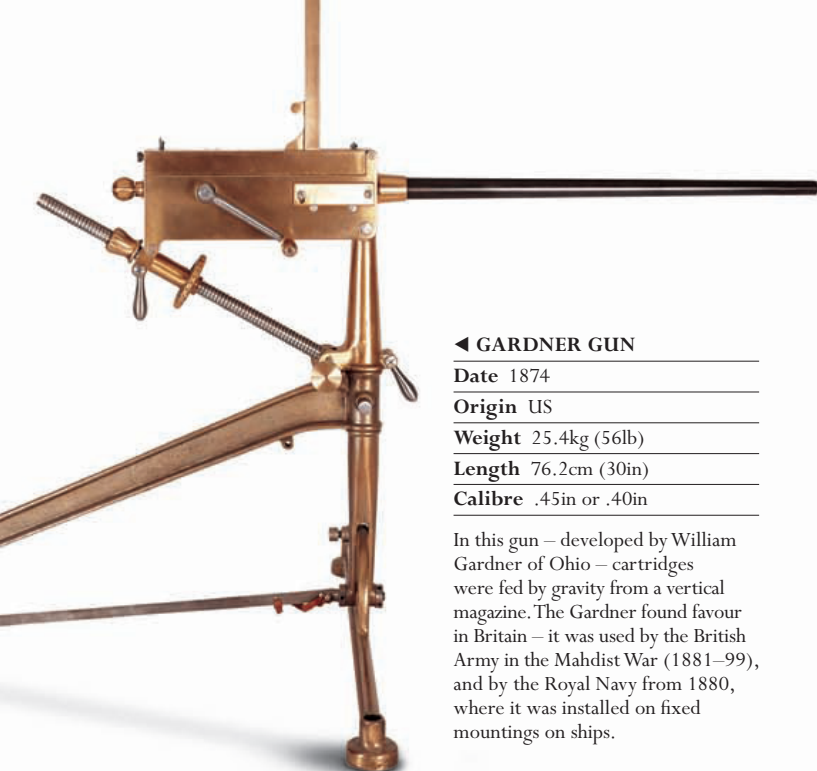




◀ GARDNER GUN

Date 1874

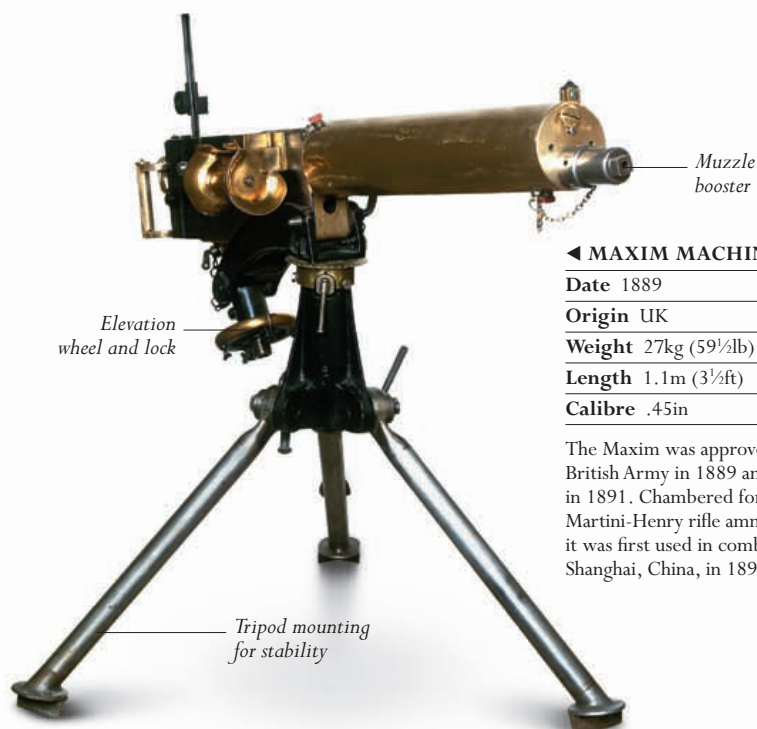
Origin US

Weight 25.4kg (56lb)

Length 76.2cm (30in)

Calibre .45in or .40in

In this gun – developed by William Gardner of Ohio – cartridges were fed by gravity from a vertical magazine. The Gardner found favour in Britain – it was used by the British Army in the Mahdist War (1881–99), and by the Royal Navy from 1880, where it was installed on fixed mountings on ships.



◀ MAXIM MACHINE-GUN

Date 1889

Origin UK

Weight 27kg (59½lb)

Length 1.1m (3½ft)

Calibre .45in

The Maxim was approved for the British Army in 1889 and issued in 1891. Chambered for the .45in Martini-Henry rifle ammunition, it was first used in combat near Shanghai, China, in 1893.



▼ MAXIM-NORDENFELT MODEL 1893

Date 1893

Origin UK

Weight 22.5kg (49½lb)

Length 1.08m (3½ft)

Calibre 11mm

Maxim and Nordenfelt entered into partnership in 1888. This 11mm Maxim-Nordenfelt, intended for French trials, featured a steam-operated trigger lock. In 1896, their joint venture was subsumed into Vickers, Sons & Maxim.



◀ COLT-BROWNING MODEL 1895

Date 1895

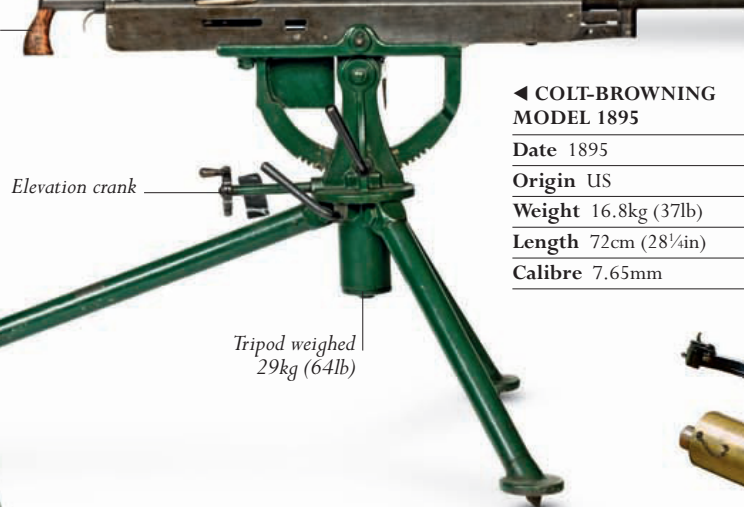
Origin US

Weight 16.8kg (37lb)

Length 72cm (28¼in)

Calibre 7.65mm

This air-cooled, gas-operated Colt-Browning 1895 had a swinging arm that descended vertically beneath the barrel when the gun was firing, earning it the nickname “the potato digger”. This gun could fire 400–500 rounds per minute.



▶ MAXIM QF 1-POUNDER “POM-POM”

Date 1890

Origin UK

Weight 186kg (410lb)

Length 1.09m (3½ft)

Calibre 37mm

The “Pom-Pom” – so-called because of the noise it made when in use – was an enlarged version of Maxim’s machine-gun. It was the world’s first autocannon – unlike a machine-gun, it fired shells rather than bullets. The “Pom-Pom” served as an artillery weapon and an anti-aircraft gun.

